

Student Life — Aug 25, 2026 (Orientation Week)

Target length: 20-30 min. Now ~18 slides after adding the Toronto weekends section — heads up this is a tighter pace than before (~1-1.5 min/slide), may want to trim once you review. Review this content before it becomes slides — edit freely.

Slide 1 — Title

Student Life MScAC Orientation Week

(subtitle, small) David — MScAC (Applied Math) 2025-2026

Slide 2 — Icebreaker: Where do you live?

Before we start... where in the GTA are you?

(Link to Google Slide)

Slide 4 — Section header

Weekends in Toronto

Slide 5 — Weekends in Toronto

Weekends in Toronto: Summer/Fall

- **Parks & waterfront:** High Park (cherry blossoms in spring), Toronto Islands (ferry ~\$10 return), Waterfront Boardwalk
 - **Neighbourhoods:** Chinatown, Koreatown (Bloor & Christie), Greektown (the Danforth), Little Italy (College St)
 - Niagara Falls (day trip, GO train or bus or car) + Niagara-On-The-Lake
 - Blue Jays game at Rogers Centre
 - Canadian National Exhibition (late August)
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Slide 6 — Weekends in Toronto

Weekends in Toronto: Spring

- Ice Skating at U of T Varsity Arena (\$3.30 rental)
- Earl Bales Ski & Snowboard Center (North York)
- Blue Mountain Ski Resort
- **Culture:** Royal Ontario Museum (student rat, also free on Tuesdays)
- **Cards to get:** PRESTO, Toronto Public Libraries

Speaker note: this is a starting list, not exhaustive — ask upper years, everyone has their own favourite spot.

Slide 7 — Section header

MScAC Student Initiative Fund

Slide 8 — Past initiatives (list)

A few things the cohort has run this year

Event	Content	Budget
Ski Trip (Blue Mountain)	Full-day ski/snowboard trip, bus + lift tickets subsidized	\$2,760
Bouldering & Social Mixer	Climbing + dinner, peer mentorship for beginners	\$1,050
Board Game Nights	4-week recurring series	\$650
CNY Celebration & Alumni Mixer	Dinner, Lo Hei, karaoke, alumni invited back	\$2,315
ML Trivia Night	Dinner + trivia ahead of recruiting season	\$960

Speaker note: these span the full range of format — one-off outings, recurring series, cultural events, alumni-inclusive events. The fund isn't just "pizza and a room."

Slide 9 — Photo collage

Look at all the fun we've had

(Grid/collage of photos from [pictures/](#) — pull a representative spread, doesn't need to map 1:1 to the events above. Pure energy/vibes slide.)

Slide 10 — Future ideas

Other ideas to start you off this Fall

Idea	Description	Cost
K1 Speed Go-Karting (North York)	Great fun near the Downsview Park TTC	\$82/person
Basecamp Climbing (Queen West)	Self-explanatory and we had dinner subsidised too	\$35/person
Canada's Wonderland	The GTA's rollercoaster park	\$45/person
Activate Toronto (Stockyards)	All-ages arcade park; 75-min active session	\$30/person

Speaker note: these are priced per person so you can see the fund goes further than you'd think — none of these require a huge ask.

Slide 11 — Running an event

Running an event in the office

- Location: MScAC Office rooms like 9016
- Food: order delivery where possible; Mother's Dumpling (Chinese), Tahini's (shawarma), pizza (you'll get sick of this)
- Stock up on cutlery, plates and cups from Dollarama
- Buy big bottles of diet coke/drinks from shoppers

Running an event outside office

- Show up, snap a picture or two, have fun

Slide 12 — Rules

Guidelines from MScAC

- Open to the entire cohort
- No alcohol, gambling / games of chance (stakes, betting pools, wagering)
- Proposal is one page: summary, goals, benefits, timeline, itemized budget (just use my Claude Code repo or something)
- You must be registered + in good academic standing (which is why us alumni need you to keep this up)

(Source: MScAC Student-led Initiatives Guidelines)

Slide 13 — The timeline

Typical timeline

- Submit a proposal 2 weeks ahead (the start of the semester is always a little busier)
- MScAC promises to confirm funding within 5 business days of your email
- After event: submit the attendance list (Partiful/written attendance sheet/Google Form), receipts, copy of original invite, and photos if applicable
- Expect reimbursement via cheque/direct deposit (if you're a TA) about 4-6 weeks after
- Past asks have ranged **\$650 – \$2,760** depending on format and scale

Slide 14 — My workflow

Student Initiatives Process

1. **Discord poll** — gauge interest before writing anything
2. **Submit one-page proposal** — real example at end of presentation
3. **Partiful** — collect RSVPs + dietary restrictions once confirmed
4. **EVENT**
5. **Submit receipts + attendee list + invitation**

6. Reimbursement lands in ~4-6 weeks

Slide 15 — Worked example: Bouldering proposal (i'm just going through the actual document yeah not on the slide)

What a real proposal actually looks like

Slide 16 — Section header

Want to run one yourself?

Slide 17 — Mentorship signup

Pick one, co-run it with me:

- K1 Speed Go-Karting (round 2)
- Basecamp Climbing
- Canada's Wonderland
- Activate Toronto

I'll help with the proposal, the budget, and the logistics to get you started.

Sign up here: *[Discord link — TBD, David to fill in]*

Slide 18 — Closing

[Discord link repeated here as a QR code once we build the pptx]